

Subject Code	ENGL3040
Subject Title	Language Matters: Navigating Social Issues through Linguistic Inquiry
Credit Value	3
Level	3
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	This subject aims to teach students to reflect on the role of linguistic knowledge in everyday situations. Specifically, it focuses on the application of linguistic knowledge to solving individual and societal issues through projects that involve exploring participants' communities, identifying an issue to study in detail, and presenting a solution. Integral to this subject are critical thinking skills that are required to go beyond superficial appearances. This is a virtual subject shared with students from a university abroad. Projects will be developed in collaboration with students from that university, introducing both sets of students to a diverse range of social issues and developing an understanding of these from an international perspective. Students will learn to work in autonomous groups and to produce and present results virtually in a cohesive and concise manner to an international audience.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: Category A: Professional/academic knowledge and skills - master key concepts in applied linguistics; - carry out a critical analysis of language in society, developing their personal integrity as responsible global citizens, particularly in the fast technological changing world, and reflect and generalize from their findings; - develop analytical tools for critically evaluating individual and social issues relating to language, including their knowledge of new technologies; - understand the role played by language, in the issue of their choosing, in their own and the country's communities; - develop the necessary skills to contact and interact professionals in their own community and gather knowledge from them. Category B: Attributes for all-roundedness - develop and use strategies for learning autonomously and collaboratively; - develop skills to communicate autonomously and collaboratively in a range of media with a range of interlocutors;

	h. learn to think out of the box and creatively to generate new ideas to exiting issues.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	Students will be able to range their own topic (and teach others about it) from the following list. Other topics will also be possible if approved by the teachers. 1. The notion of an international language; 2. The notion of the native speaker; 3. Teaching and learning languages in various contexts; 4. Language and sign language rehabilitation, helping all to speak or communicate; 5. Interpreting and translation; 6. Language variation, including social and geographical variation; 7. Languages in contact, including pidginisation and creolisation; 8. Language planning: status, corpus, acquisition; 9. Language and identity, including gender and cultural identity; 10. Language change; 11. Style, context, and register; 12. Language attitudes; 13. Language in the metaverse.
Teaching/ Learning Methodology	Learning will take place through the work carried out by the students who will work in groups throughout the semester. The pedagogical approach will be based on a three step Design Thinking pedagogical programme, called ECO (Explore, Create, Offer): 1. Explore: Initially, in Weeks 1-6, lectures and seminars will be spent exploring and evaluating language issues affecting Hong Kong and other communities and developing ideas that could be turned into a project. Students will be expected to do this autonomously (with the teachers' guidance whenever required), and to keep an individual diary of their progress. In Week 7, students will present their findings, including a topic to develop further. These presentations will be evaluated by the teacher and other students. Together with the presentation, students will hand in a portfolio describing their explorations. 2. Create: In Weeks 8-13, students will focus on one topic, developing it in depth and comparing the situation between HK and the foreign country. They will identify the various factors affecting the issue and begin to brainstorm potential solutions to that issue. During this stage (if not before) students are expected to identify their communities' stakeholders and contact them to truly understand their situation. Lecture and seminar time will provide a common virtual place to plan and discuss in teams. 3. Offer:

	At the end of the semester (exact date to be confirmed with the foreign institution) students will present the issues they have explored and the proposed solutions. These will be teacher and peer-evaluated. In addition: • Each group will prepare a short video or a poster summarizing their work (no more than 5 minutes). These will be shared with the stakeholders and presented at a Student’s conference (either at PolyU or at the foreign university). • Each group will also hand in their final portfolio, with a complete report of their progress, difficulties, and solutions from the beginning of term. • Each student will also hand in a self-reflective diary. Both the midterm and end-of-term presentations will be opportunities for students to learn from each other, as each team will be developing a different topic (from the list mentioned under Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus above or others as agreed with the teachers).																																																																														
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	The assessment tasks are designed to meet the ILOs and to ensure that students’ performance is captured in different conditions, settings and media. <table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="8">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th><th>e</th><th>f</th><th>g</th><th>h</th></tr><tr><td>1. Presentation 1 (group)</td><td>20%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>2. Presentation 2 (group)</td><td>20%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>3. Portfolio +Video (group)</td><td>30%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>4. Self-reflective diary (individual)</td><td>30%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td></td><td></td><td colspan="8"></td></tr></table>	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)								a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	1. Presentation 1 (group)	20%	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	2. Presentation 2 (group)	20%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	3. Portfolio +Video (group)	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	4. Self-reflective diary (individual)	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	Total	100 %																		
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	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Private study	29 Hrs.
	▪ Take-home assignments	58 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	126 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Sources of ideas: Brenzinger, M. (ed.). (2007). <i>Language diversity endangered</i>. Mouton de Gruyter. Chambers, J.K. (2003). <i>Sociolinguistic theory: Linguistic variation and its social significance</i> (2nd edition). Blackwell. Coulmas, F. (2005). <i>Sociolinguistics: The study of speakers' choices</i>. Blackwell. Duchêne, A., Moyer, M., & Roberts, C. (Eds.). (2013). <i>Language, migration and social inequalities: A critical sociolinguistic perspective on institutions and work</i> (Vol. 2). Multilingual Matters. Duff, P. (2008). <i>Case study research in applied linguistics</i>. Lawrence Erlbaum Associates. Fairclough, N. (2013). <i>Language and power</i>. Routledge. Freire, P., & Macedo, D. (2005). <i>Literacy: Reading the word and the world</i>. Routledge. García, O., Flores, N., & Spotti, M. (Eds.). (2017). <i>The Oxford handbook of language and society</i>. Oxford University Press. Maurais, J. and Morris, M.A. (2003). <i>Languages in a globalising world</i>. Cambridge University Press. Montgomery, M. (2008). <i>An introduction to language and society</i>. Routledge. Romaine, S. (2000). <i>Language in society: An introduction to sociolinguistics</i>. Oxford University Press. Trudgill, P. (2000). <i>Sociolinguistics: An introduction to language and society</i>. Penguin. Wardhaugh, R., & Fuller, J. M. (2021). <i>An introduction to sociolinguistics</i>. John Wiley & Sons. Practical guides: Holmes, J., & Hazen, K. (2013). <i>Research methods in sociolinguistics: a practical guide</i> (Vol. 5). Wiley. Schilling, N. (2013). <i>Sociolinguistic Fieldwork</i>. Cambridge University Press. https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9780511980541	